DISSERTATION RESEARCH / PUBLIC PORTFOLIO EDITION

Agricultural credit access and the Dvara-linked KhetScore model

A field-based study with farmers in Dudu and Phagi, Jaipur district, Rajasthan

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Working on my dissertation research.

Research overview

This study examines how farmers experience the Dvara-linked KhetScore agricultural lending process in selected rural areas of Jaipur district. It asks whether a technology-supported assessment process can make credit more practically accessible, how field-level assistance shapes that experience, and what barriers remain around awareness, loan information, repayment and agricultural risk.

The study treats access as more than loan approval. It considers whether borrowers understand the process, can obtain clear information and receive support that fits the realities of rural livelihoods.

Public edition	This brief summarizes the dissertation document supplied for portfolio use. It is not the full-length dissertation. Participant-level stories, interview schedules, field notes and photographs of other people are not reproduced.

01 / DESIGN AND EVIDENCE

How the study was conducted

The dissertation uses a descriptive and exploratory mixed-methods design. Survey responses describe participants' reported experiences; qualitative material provides context about how the lending process works in practice.

116	4	6
farmer survey participants	institutional staff interviews	local stakeholders in one contextual focus group

Evidence and scope

The field study draws on a structured survey with 116 farmers who had used, benefited from or directly interacted with the lending process. It also uses interviews with four Dvara staff members, field observations, telephonic interactions and a focus group with six local stakeholders. The focus group was used for contextual need assessment, not as representative evidence of borrower outcomes.

The study area covers selected villages in Dudu and Phagi tehsils of Jaipur district. The sample was selected purposively and is not designed to represent all farmers in Rajasthan or India.

Research question

How do farmers experience access to credit through the Dvara-linked KhetScore process, and how do awareness, field support, loan information and local livelihood conditions shape that experience?

The analysis combines descriptive statistics with thematic interpretation. The study examines reported access, loan use, repayment experience, digital awareness, field support and satisfaction. It does not technically audit the KhetScore algorithm.

Reading the evidence carefully
The findings describe experiences and perceptions within this purposive field sample. They should not be read as a causal estimate of the model's effect or as an evaluation of the underlying scoring technology.

What the field evidence suggests

The dissertation presents a mixed picture: many participants described the lending process as relatively accessible, while the support and information around a loan remained central to how people experienced it.

Selected findings

- Among 103 participants who answered the previous-borrowing question, 31.1% reported that they had not taken a loan before joining the Dvara/KhetScore-linked process. This is a sample-specific descriptive result.
- Field Survey Officers and local contacts often helped participants navigate onboarding and documentation. The study therefore describes access as assisted in practice, rather than as independent use of a digital tool.
- Many participants had limited awareness of KhetScore itself. Participation in a technology-supported loan process did not necessarily mean that borrowers understood the assessment mechanism.
- Land-related verification continued to matter. The findings suggest that a new assessment approach can widen a credit pathway without removing every documentation or access barrier.
- Participants' reported experiences also raised questions about repayment timing, clear loan information, consistent field support, women's direct participation and exposure to crop or income risks.

Limits and interpretation

The sample was purposive and limited to selected operational areas. Findings rely partly on self-reported experience and do not establish long-term changes in income, crop yield or productivity. The study did not independently verify each loan's formal terms and did not examine the model's internal algorithm or decision rules.

The central conclusion is measured: the process appears to have offered an additional route to credit for some participating farmers, but the quality of inclusion also depends on borrower awareness, transparency, human support and the ability to manage agricultural risk.

Privacy note
The source dissertation contains anonymized but detailed participant stories and photographs that show other people. Those materials are withheld from this public portfolio edition to reduce the risk of identification. The full source file has not been uploaded.

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